



Abera Abdeta Kitaba, Ph.D. (Candidate)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Motivated biomedical researcher with a Ph.D. thesis completed and submitted in the Department of Health Technology and Informatics at The Hong Kong Polytechnic University. Proven track record of high-impact journal publications and hands-on expertise in bacterial culture, mammalian cell culture, and molecular biology techniques such as PCR, ELISA, DNA and RNA sequencing, as well as bioinformatics analysis. Seeking a postdoctoral research position in biomedical sciences, including antimicrobial resistance and host-pathogen interactions.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Health Technology and Informatics | Expected 2026

Department of Health Technology and Informatics (HTI)

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University (PolyU), Hong Kong

Thesis Status: Thesis Submitted (Awaiting oral defense)

Supervisor: Prof. LEUNG Hang Mei, Polly

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

- I submitted two manuscripts to peer-reviewed journals from my Ph.D. research.

Research interest: Antimicrobial resistance, outer membrane vesicles, long non-coding RNAs, and host-pathogen interactions.



Educational background

- **Master of Science (M.Sc.) in [Clinical Laboratory Science/Diagnostic and Public Health Microbiology] | 2018 – 2020; cGPA=3.98/4.0**
 - Addis Ababa University, Ethiopia
- **Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) in [Medical Laboratory Sciences] | 2012 – 2016**
 - Addis Ababa University, Ethiopia
 - **Honors:** First Class Honors with Very great distinction (**Highest CGPA 3.93 out of 4** in the Department of medical laboratory sciences and the College of health sciences)
 - **Awards:** University **Gold Medallist** (Ranked 1st among graduating students of the College of Health Sciences in 2016)

TECHNICAL & LABORATORY SKILLS

- Bacterial culture and Mammalian cell culture
- DNA and RNA sequencing, proteome analysis
- Bioinformatics analysis

- RT-qPCR and ELISA
- Confocal microscopy and Transmission electron microscopy
- Outer membrane vesicle isolation and Nanoparticle tracking analysis

RESEARCH & WORK EXPERIENCE

- Worked on different research projects at the Ethiopian Public Health Institute from 2016 to 2023.

PUBLICATIONS

1. **Kitaba AA**, Bongor ZT, Beyene D, Ayenew Z, Tsige E, Kefale TA, Mekonnen Y, Teklu DS, Seyoum E, Negeri AA. Antimicrobial resistance trends in clinical *Escherichia coli* and *Klebsiella pneumoniae* in Ethiopia. *African journal of laboratory medicine*. 2024;13(1):1-7.
2. **Abdeta A**, Negeri AA, Beyene D, Adamu E, Fekede E, Fentaw S, Tesfaye M, Wakoya GK. Prevalence and trends of carbapenem-resistant *Pseudomonas aeruginosa* and *Acinetobacter* species isolated from clinical specimens at the Ethiopian Public Health Institute, Addis Ababa, Ethiopia: A Retrospective Analysis. *Infection and Drug Resistance*. 2023 Dec 31:1381-90.
3. **Abdeta A**, Beyene D, Negeri AA. Antimicrobial resistance patterns of *Staphylococcus aureus* and enterococcus species at the Ethiopian Public Health Institute, Ethiopia: A five-year retrospective analysis. *Infection and Drug Resistance*. 2023 Dec 31:6155-66.
4. **Abdeta A**, Bitew A, Fentaw S, Tsige E, Assefa D, Lejisa T, Kefyalew Y, Tigabu E, Evans M. Phenotypic characterization of carbapenem non-susceptible gram-negative bacilli isolated from clinical specimens. *Plos one*. 2021 Dec 2;16(12):e0256556.
5. Negeri AA, Getu M, Teklu DS, Ayana D, Basheha C, **Kitaba AA**, Sura T, Ayenew Z, Birhanu BG, Gobena MT, Gobene DB. Genomic characterization of carbapenem-resistant *Acinetobacter baumannii* isolates from the National Clinical Bacteriology Reference Laboratory, Ethiopia. *BMC Genomics*. 2026 Aug 29.
6. Regassa BT, Tosisa W, Eshetu D, Beyene D, **Abdeta A**, Negeri AA, Teklu DS, Tasew G, Tulu B, Awoke T. Antimicrobial resistance profiles of bacterial isolates from clinical specimens referred to Ethiopian Public Health Institute: analysis of 5-year data. *BMC Infectious Diseases*. 2023 Nov 15;23(1):798.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

1. **Abera Abdeta KITABA**, Abebe Mekuria SHENKUTIE, Polly HM LEUNG. Selective Enrichment of Regulatory and Small RNAs in Outer Membrane Vesicles Derived from Carbapenem-Resistant *Acinetobacter baumannii*. 15th International Symposium on Antimicrobial Agents and Resistance 2026, held from 12-14 June 2026, Hong Kong Convention & Exhibition Centre, China.
2. **Abera Abdeta KITABA**, Polly HM LEUNG. Outer membrane vesicles from carbapenem-resistant *A. baumannii* reshape macrophage immune responses, with long non-coding RNAs and alternative splicing serving as regulatory layers. Early Career Summer Conference 2026, held at The Exchange, University of Birmingham, on 6th and 7th of July 2026, United Kingdom
3. **A. Abdeta**, A. Bitew, S. Fentaw, E. Tsige, D. Assefa, T. Lejisa, Y. Kefyalew, E. Tigabu, M. Evans. Phenotypic Characterization Of Carbapenem Non-susceptible Gram-negative Bacilli Isolated From Clinical Specimens: held from June 9–13, 2022, in Washington, D.C. United States

FELLOWSHIPS

- The Hong Kong PhD Fellowship Scheme (HKPFS), 2023-2026
- PolyU Presidential PhD Fellowship Scheme (PPPFS) cash award, HK\$80,000

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS & SERVICE

- American Society for Microbiology (ASM)

REFERENCES

Prof. LEUNG Hang Mei, Polly

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